

RESEARCH MEMORANDUM

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THE SEFER RAZIEL: THE BOOK OF THE SECRETS OF GOD

A SURVEY OF THE DOCUMENTED RECORD
WITH FULL SOURCE CITATIONS

SUBJECT: Sefer Raziel HaMalakh ('The Book of Raziel the Angel'): what it claims to be, its rival account of Genesis, its account of the one language, what it says it is for, and its echoes in Hermeticism, the Neoplatonists, and C.G. Jung.

METHOD: Point-form summary of the primary texts and academic scholarship. All claims are cited to their sources in the final section.

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I. THE BOOK OF THE SECRETS OF GOD -- WHAT 'RAZIEL' MEANS

- RAZIEL = RAZ ('secret') + EL ('power'): **'the Secrets of EL.'** A MALAKH -- literally **'messenger': a function, not a species** -- stationed closest to the source, **who hears everything that passes there. ELOHIM itself is grammatically plural.** (Scholem 1974; Brown-Driver-Briggs.)
- Folk belief held that **a house containing the book cannot burn** -- it was owned as a protective object as much as read. (Trachtenberg 1939.)
- Not authored by any man -- **handed down by a messenger: the underlying alphabet of reality, and the alphabet is executable.** (Ginzberg 1909; Savedow 2000; Scholem 1965.)

II. THE TRUE PURPOSE OF GENESIS

- The title page names the book in Aramaic: 'ZEH SIFRA D'ADAM KADMAAH' -- **'This is the Book of the FIRST ADAM (ADAM KADMAAH), which Raziel the angel gave him.'** (Sefer Raziel 1881, title page.)
- Adam's petition: **'since I ate from the tree of knowledge, my wisdom has been hidden from me... let me know what will come upon me and upon my generations, on every day and in every month, and do not conceal from me the wisdom of Your angels.'** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 3.)
- **'After three days of his supplications, the malakh Raziel came to him, as he sat by the river that flows out of Eden, and appeared to him in the heat of the day with the book in his hand,'** and said: **'Adam, why are you bewildered? Why do you grieve? Your words have been heard. I have come to make you wise.'** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 3.)

- **JOSH NOTE: ADAM** means human-kind, not a single man. This book is for all of us -- the manual to the operating system. But why?
- 'At the moment Adam took the book, a fire rose up on the bank of the river, and the malakh ascended in the flame of the fire, **HASHAMAYMAH**' -- 'to the **HEAVENS**': plural in Hebrew, layered realms, the seven this book maps. The flame is what a malakh IS -- 'His ministers a **FLAMING FIRE**' (Psalm 104:4) -- and Ezekiel's vehicle glows with **CHASHMAL**: not fire, not metal, a glow the language had no word for; the Talmud reads it as living fire that speaks; modern Hebrew took it for **ELECTRICITY**. The Sefer Raziel itself carries a section headed **SOD HA-MERKABAH** -- '**THE SECRET OF THE VEHICLE**'. (Sefer Raziel 1881, fols. 3-4; Psalm 104:4; Ezekiel 1:4; Chagigah 13b.)
- **The OTHER malakhim objected.** A faction held this knowledge should not be in human hands: they stole the book from Adam and threw it into the sea; Rahab, the prince of the sea, was ordered to dive down and return it. (Ginzberg 1909.)
 - The objection runs through **multiple traditions**: at the creation of man the ministering malakhim protested, and companies of them were burned for it (Sanhedrin 38b). And in 1 Enoch the leak runs the other way: a faction called **THE WATCHERS** descends and teaches humans forbidden arts -- metallurgy, sorcery, the courses of the stars -- and is imprisoned for the unauthorized transfer (1 Enoch 8). Two factions, two policies on what humans are allowed to know.
 - **JOSH NOTE: this must tie into Archons, or Greys, or both.**
 - The Gnostic scriptures name the gatekeepers outright: the Nag Hammadi text '**The Hypostasis of the Archons**' ('**The Reality of the Rulers**') describes the **ARCHONS** -- rulers who withhold knowledge from Adam and try to keep mankind asleep -- the same faction, under its Greek name. (Nag Hammadi Codex II,4; Robinson 1977.)

III. THE OPERATING MANUAL -- THE FIRST BOOK

- The printed introduction promises: 'this is new -- yet it has already existed for ages: by it one can know all hidden and concealed knowledge... to see through the shining lenses (**ASPAKLARIOT**)... the pure Utterances that issue from the Ten Sefirot.' (Sefer Raziel 1881, introduction.)
 - The **ASPAKLARIA** is the lens of prophetic seeing: every prophet saw through a dim one, **Moses alone through a clear one.** (Yevamot 49b.)
- A manual for a **layered cosmos**: seven heavens, each with named staff, schedules, and permissions -- and the Names by which things are made and unmade. Reality answers to exact names, exactly pronounced. (Sayedow 2000; Morgan 1983; Trachtenberg 1939.)
- The ancient core, Sefer HaRazim (c. 3rd-4th century), is one of the oldest spell books in the world -- lost for centuries, reconstructed in 1966 from the Cairo Geniza. Recipe format, not scripture format: what to write, what to say, at what hour. (Morgan 1983; Margalioth 1966.)

- Among the procedures: **question the spirits of the dead; see the sun at night; and a prayer to Helios, the Greek sun god, hidden in Hebrew letters.** (Morgan 1983.)
- It prints **angelic alphabets -- 'celestial writing,' the script of the malakhim.** (Sefer Raziel 1701.)

IV. THE LANGUAGE THAT BUILDS WORLDS AND THE PRINCES OF THE NATIONS

- The one language was Hebrew -- **'the tongue of creation,'** the letters the world was spoken in -- **lost at the collapse, and later re-taught to Abraham by a malakh.** (Jubilees 12:25-27, in Charlesworth 1985.)
- The engine is acoustic: **KOL-RUACH-DIBBUR -- voice, breath, speech --** the letters mapped onto the vocal apparatus. (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 14; John 1:1.)
- Talmud, Berakhot 55a: Bezalel, builder of the Tabernacle, **'knew how to combine the letters by which heaven and earth were created.'** A man, named in scripture, credited with knowing the combination. (Berakhot 55a.)
- And the code runs: the **golem --** masters of Sefer Yetzirah ('The Book of Formation') are said to have **animated a body of clay by permuting the letters,** and powered it down by erasing one letter (**EMET, 'truth,' becomes MET, 'dead'**). (Scholem 1965; Kaplan 1990.)
- **Seventy nations, seventy languages, seventy princes -- one heavenly administrator per fragment of the broken original** (3 Enoch 17); the oldest text of Deuteronomy (Qumran) has the nations divided **'according to the number of the SONS OF ELOHIM'** -- and the princes fight each other: Daniel's messenger, **delayed twenty-one days by 'the PRINCE OF PERSIA'.** (Deuteronomy 32:8, 4QDeut-j; Daniel 10:13; Charlesworth 1983.)
- The pagan Neoplatonists held the same rule: **divine names must never be translated -- the power is in the original sounds, not the meaning.** (Iamblichus, De Mysteriis VII.)

V. THE SAME REVELATION IN OTHER ROBES -- HERMES AND THE NEOPLATONISTS

- Egypt's version: Thoth / Hermes Trismegistus, **scribe of the gods.** In the Poimandres, **a vast mind appears to Hermes and shows him how the cosmos was generated from the Word.** (Copenhaver 1992.)
- The Emerald Tablet of Hermes: **'that which is below is like that which is above'** -- one code running at every scale. (Tabula Smaragdina; Principe 2013.)
- And the polarity principle, inside the Hebrew spell book itself: **everything created runs male/female -- polarity through all things.** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 16.)
- Philo: the creator works like **an architect who first forms the entire city in his own mind -- the world exists in consciousness before it exists at all** (De Opificio Mundi 17-20); Plotinus's emanation -- One, Mind, Soul, world -- **maps the same descending architecture as the sefirot.** (Enneads; Scholem

1941.)

- **King Alfonso X of Castile had the Sefer Raziel translated into Latin** (13th century) -- **a royal court commissioning an angel's book.** (Page 2012.)
- Pico della Mirandola, to Rome, 1486: **'no science assures us more of the divinity of Christ than magic and Cabala.'** (Pico 1486; Yates 1964.)
- Agrippa's Three Books of Occult Philosophy (1533) -- the backbone of Western occultism -- **imports the name-magic, letter-tables, and hierarchies wholesale.** (Agrippa 1533.)

VI. JUNG

- Jung's late masterwork *Mysterium Coniunctionis* is built in large part on Kabbalistic material -- above all **ADAM KADMON, the primordial cosmic Adam**, whom Jung reads as the archetype of the Self: **the first man who contained the whole.** (Jung, CW 14.)
 - Set that beside the Sefer Raziel's own title page: **'the Book of ADAM KADMAAH -- the First Adam.'** (Sefer Raziel 1881, title page; Jung, CW 14.)
- In 1944, after a heart attack, Jung recorded visions of himself inside Kabbalah: the Garden of Pomegranates, witnessing **the wedding of Tifereth with Malchuth** -- the union at the center of the sefirot. (Jung 1963, ch. 'Visions.')
- Jung's own received text: 1916, his house feeling **crowded with the dead**, he wrote the Seven Sermons to the Dead in three evenings, in the voice of a 2nd-century Gnostic -- **a modern man taking dictation.** It seeded the Red Book. (Jung 1963; Jung 2009.)
- The **collective unconscious** -- the same figures surfacing in patients **who had no cultural access to them** -- and his name for inner and outer lining up without cause: **SYNCHRONICITY.** (Jung, CW 9i; Jung 1952.)

APPENDIX -- INSIDE THE BOOK: TABLES, SPELLS, AND KEEPERS

- The book is **formatted like a technical manual, not scripture**: running text in one typeface, commentary in another, and between them -- **tables of administrators, printed letter-arrays, circular seals, figure-plates, and boxed glosses.** (Sefer Raziel 1881, passim.)
- A **planetary administrator roster, printed as a table**: Michael over Saturn, Gabriel over Mars, Chasdiel over Venus, Barkiel over Jupiter, Raphael over the Sun, Tzadkiel over Mercury, Anael over the Moon -- **one named functionary per planet.** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 26.)
- The sun enters and exits through **numbered WINDOWS in the firmament** -- 182 in the east, 182 in the west -- **the same portal cosmology as 1 Enoch's Astronomical Book.** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 29; 1 Enoch 72.)
- The raw arrays, **printed on the page**: the **42-Letter Name** in triplets and the **full 72 Names in sequence** -- with the flat statement that the 72-fold Name **breaks all witchcraft.** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fols. 38, 62.)

- The vowel table, printed under the heading '**THE SECRET OF CAIN, ABEL, AND SETH -- THE BODY, ITS SOUL, AND ITS INTELLECT**': the spelled-out Four-Letter Name, with the operation **selected by the vowel it is pronounced with** -- KAMATZ for dominion, SEGOL for love, CHIRIK to fell an enemy, CHOLAM for wealth, SHURUK **to know what is to come and for protection from all harmers and shedim**, SHEVA to heal the sick. **One Name, ten operations -- the vowel is the selector.** It closes: '**a hidden secret -- the one who understands will understand.**' (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 52.)
- The lock and the key: **a Torah scroll carries consonants only** -- the vowels are not letters, and for most of history **the pronunciation was carried by living memory alone, teacher to student, mouth to ear**, until the Masoretes wrote the dots down centuries later. **The consonants are public; the pronunciation is the key, and the key was oral.** (Tov 2012.)
 - **JOSH NOTE: encryption with a key -- from a time when someone still remembered that Hebrew was a theurgic language: literally a control system.**
- **THE DREAM QUESTION (SHE'ELAT CHALOM):** a procedure to **submit a question at night and receive the answer in a dream** -- the same mechanism as the Greek dream-incubation temples: **a query interface.** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 52.)
- The distances between the heavens are **measured: a 500-YEAR JOURNEY between each layer**, camps of thousands, **rivers of fire.** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 23; Chagigah 13a.)
 - **JOSH NOTE: we each must incarnate for 500 years before ascending?**
- **SHIUR KOMAH -- 'The Measure of the Body'** -- transmitted by Rabbi Yishmael from the mouth of **METATRON: the dimensions of the divine body, in parasangs.** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 56; Cohen 1983.)
 - The numbers: **each sole of the feet, 30,000,000 parasangs** -- and the soles are **named: PARSIMYA (right), AGTAMON (left); ankles to knees 190,004,000; total height 2,360,000,000 parasangs.** And a single divine **SPAN fills the universe from end to end.** (Cohen 1983.)
 - The deliberate paradox: **a finite total height built from units each larger than the universe -- the measureless measure.** (Cohen 1983; Scholem 1941.)
 - Maimonides was alarmed enough to rule the text should be **erased and its very mention suppressed**; the mystics answered that the numbers are **measures of divine energy, not flesh** -- and that **reciting the measurements itself secures a place in the world to come.** (Maimonides, Responsa no. 117; Scholem 1941.)
- The transmission line: Adam -> **Enoch** -> Noah -> Abraham -> Moses -> **Solomon.** The hiding place of the book is **shown to Enoch in a dream**; the word to Noah: '**from it you will learn to make an ark of gopher wood**' -- and the book rode inside the ark **in a case of gold.** (Sefer Raziel 1881, fols. 3-4; Ginzberg 1909; Morgan 1983.)
- The same tradition-cluster carries the Lilith material: the Sefer Raziel prints the famous childbirth amulet naming the three angels -- Senoy,

Sansenoy, Semangelof -- **against Lilith, the night visitor**. (Sefer Raziel, Amsterdam 1701; Trachtenberg 1939.)

- The amulet's three protectors are drawn as **BIRD-BODIED beings** -- and the **avian guardian recurs everywhere the tradition touches**: the eagle-headed APKALLU sages guarding Mesopotamian reliefs, Egypt's falcon-headed Horus and ibis-headed Thoth, and the **eagle-faced living creature at the throne** in Ezekiel and Revelation. (Sefer Raziel 1881, fol. 62; Black & Green 1992; Ezekiel 1:10; Revelation 4:7.)

-- **JOSH NOTE: why are the protectors avian? A real avian species -- or the form these beings choose to be seen in, the way Greys put on suits and hats to talk to people? All of it spurring us to understand 'holy' as higher energy, higher vibration?**

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